

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 6, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:73-88

73 Your hands have made me and fashioned me; Give me understanding, that I may learn Your commandments.

74 Those who fear You will be glad when they see me, Because I have hoped in Your word.

75 I know, O LORD, that Your judgments are right, And that in faithfulness You have afflicted me.

76 Let, I pray, Your merciful kindness be for my comfort, According to Your word to Your servant.

77 Let Your tender mercies come to me, that I may live; For Your law is my delight.

78 Let the proud be ashamed, For they treated me wrongfully with falsehood; But I will meditate on Your precepts.

79 Let those who fear You turn to me, Those who know Your testimonies.

80 Let my heart be blameless regarding Your statutes, That I may not be ashamed.

81 My soul faints for Your salvation, But I hope in Your word.

82 My eyes fail from searching Your word, Saying, "When will You comfort me?"

83 For I have become like a wineskin in smoke, Yet I do not forget Your statutes.

84 How many are the days of Your servant? When will You execute judgment on those who persecute me?

85 The proud have dug pits for me, Which is not according to Your law.

86 All Your commandments are faithful; They persecute me wrongfully; Help me!

87 They almost made an end of me on earth, But I did not forsake Your precepts.

88 Revive me according to Your lovingkindness, So that I may keep the testimony of Your

mouth.

II. Key Summary

- The psalmist asks the God who made and fashioned him for understanding, so that he can learn God's commandments; he also says that those who fear God will be glad when they see him hoping in God's word (vv. 73-74).
 - The psalmist says God's judgments are right and that God afflicted him in faithfulness; at the same time he asks God, according to His word, for merciful kindness to comfort him and tender mercies to keep him alive (vv. 75-77).
 - Facing proud people who wrong him with falsehood, dig pits for him, and persecute him, the psalmist says his soul faints for God's salvation and his eyes fail from waiting on God's promise, like a wineskin in smoke; yet he does not forget God's statutes or forsake His precepts, and he ends by asking God to revive him according to His lovingkindness (vv. 78-88).
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III. Passage Analysis

Being Hurt Doesn't Mean God Has Let Go of You

God's purpose is to use suffering to build us up, not to ruin us; so we can freely ask Him, according to His covenant promise, to "comfort me with Your merciful kindness" in the middle of affliction. [1]

In the middle of a hard season the psalmist says, "in faithfulness You have afflicted me" (v. 75). He isn't saying the pain is a good thing — he's saying God hasn't lied to him and hasn't walked away, which is exactly why he keeps asking God for comfort instead of walking off himself.

Trials Are Smoke, Not Fire

Our trials are smoke, but not fire; they are very uncomfortable, but they do not consume us. [2]

The "wineskin in smoke" in verse 83 is something blackened, shriveled, and apparently

useless — that's how the psalmist describes himself. Smoke chokes you and makes you miserable, but it doesn't burn you up; even at his worst he still says, "Yet I do not forget Your statutes."

IV. Reflection Question

What is something in your life right now that you have been waiting on for a while, with no idea when you will get an answer?

The psalmist was waiting too. He asked God straight out, "When will You comfort me?" — and while he waited, he still said that God had afflicted him in faithfulness.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website (ccbiblestudy.org), Comprehensive Bible Interpretation on Psalm 119,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/19Psa/19GT119.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Psalm 119 (quoting Charles Spurgeon),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>